



Modern warships

HMS *Diamond* UK 1952



390 ft (119 m) long

Crane for deploying equipment or recovering mines



151 ft (46 m) long

Twin propellers powered by diesel engine

HMS *Kirkliston*
UK 1954

The ship's Tomahawk missiles have a range of more than **800 miles** (1,300 km).

USS *Arleigh Burke*
USA 1991



505 ft (154 m) long

Merlin helicopter



Turret with two 4.5 in (113 mm) guns with a range of 11 miles (18 km)

Twin propellers

Tracking antenna can receive data sent from satellites or rockets

Ship manned by a crew of 120 as well as up to 100 technical experts



Monge A601 France 1990 738 ft (225 m) long

Tomahawk cruise missiles can launch vertically from this launch grid

Sikorsky SH-60 Seahawk helicopter on helipad

Aircraft carriers and nuclear submarines have taken over from battleships as the biggest and most lethal craft in a navy's fleet. Yet there remains plenty of work for smaller ships, which are built to perform a wide variety of important roles.

Frigates like **HMS *Lancaster*** and **HMCS *Vancouver*** are multipurpose—able to protect and escort other ships, perform coastal patrols, intercept suspicious ships, and engage in antisubmarine warfare. The **USS *Arleigh Burke*** destroyer also tackles submarines, as well as